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Subject: CP - work update, weeks ending 09/12/2008
Date: Sunday, September 14, 2008 9:38:34 PM

On my Plate

- EPHT – Portal development
- Lead maps, reporting
 - Water CWG – data, conference calls, ~~sharing agreement~~
 - Address Geocoding Tool
 - Asthma/air surveillance
 - Cognos assistance
 - Arsenic in wells mapping project
 - Birth outcomes multi-state project
- Lead - address cleaning/geocoding, 2003-2007
- [?] Battelle risk prediction project
- Cancer – North Deering inquiry
- geocoding protocol
- Program – Arsenic exposure study
- ME-CDC – Data Access Workgroup
- USM – misc.

These weeks' activities

EPHT

Portal development

Data acquisition and compilation:

- Block Group boundaries for Maine
- Census Block Group level data (2000) for Population age <6; and Housing units by Year Built
- Block Group assignment of geocoded Lead addresses (2003-2007)

Quick Facts text

Review, workgroup discussion

Roles

Review, comments

Lead maps, reports – comments/discussion on Kathy and Lisa's samples.

Water CWG – Conference calls. Discussion of sample displays for NCDMs, and draft text for national site.

Address Geocoding Tool – introduced the Tool (verbally) at the ME-CDC GIS user's group. Some Infect. Disease epi's seem interested and have timely needs. Still waiting for functional version of the batch interface. Mike F. proved that he can run it "locally" but the web interface sure doesn't work yet. Don't want to recruit beta testers until it does.

Asthma/Air Surveillance – Publication proof: answered queries and read through it for typos and errors.

Birth Outcomes multi-state analysis – no news.

Arsenic in wells mapping project – Met with Martha Nielsen, and assembled data for her to use. Data included:

- Legacy HETL data (1990-2003)
- Recent HETL data (2005-2006)
- MTBE survey data
- Arsenic Bathing Study pre-filter results
- Columbia U. data
- Census well water used data (1990 census)

Note: we discussed that much of the recent HETL data is lacking addresses, and this could be retrieved by digging deeper into the lab database. But for now, we're leaving that aside, pending Martha's assessment of need. If she does a town-by-town analysis, she can use the "sample town" field.

You might want to take a look at a compilation of maps I put together:

<S:\EPHT\EPHI Feasibility\Arsenic in well water\Data for USGS\Arsenic map comparisons.doc>

At the end of this comparison, it seemed to me that it could be useful just to create an updated version of the style of map/analysis that Marc Loiselle did (i.e., combining max values by town, along with the point display).

Other EPHT – planning group for GIS workshop in November at Rutgers. This is the thing that Dan W. is spearheading. I (and others) have sought to make sure that the topics have direct relevance to portal development. Of course it's partly driven by who knows who and who will be invited. Some people have made contacts with Google.org representatives and other interesting folk. Likely topics to be covered: map smoothing; handling confidentiality; cartographic issues; tracking air quality.

Lead

Data request – Portland (Toho). My indirect involvement is that I cleaned up the town ascriptions in the 2003-2007 data, so Kathy's job in producing the requested data will be straightforward.

Address cleaning/geocoding, general data QC – invested time in translating/cleaning town names for the 2003-2007 data. This relates to the ~20% or so of screening addresses that were not street-level geocoded. It means a) converting locality names to actual town names, and b) cleaning up misplings. May's efforts will (eventually) supercede this.

Battelle risk prediction project – letting it drop? Haven't heard anything.

New Director candidate talks – cost me \$75 in child care to hear Sue and Eric's talks – but I'm glad I did!

Cancer

North Deering inquiry – No developments that I've heard.

Geocoding protocol – Nothing new.

Program

Arsenic Exposure Study – No news.

ME-CDC

Data Workgroup – no news.

USM

Meetings, goings-on – Faculty meetings resume next week.

Deadlines

Demo Maps for Portal – 9/18.

Text, reports, etc. for Water – 12/1.

Time spent:

- 75% - EPHT Portal-related (includes Lead)
- 15% - Lead support/data request
- <5% - Water CWG: data generation, conference calls
- <5% - Geocoding Tool development
- <5% - ME-CDC Data Access Workgroup

<5% - this update